VIT Bhopal University
VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

Digital Literacy Portfolio

Project Report

Course Code	CSE0001
Course Title	Digital Literacy
Student Name	Saswata Chakrabarti
Registration No.	25BCE10434
Year / Branch	1st Year – B.Tech (CSE)
Date	March 2026

GitHub Repository: https://github.com/saswatachakrabarti/digital-literacy-project

Introduction

This project is part of the CSE0001 – Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. As part of the course, I have taken on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, with the responsibility of helping my peers navigate the digital world effectively and safely.

The project is organised into five tasks, each mapping to a module of the course. These tasks cover creating a digital literacy infographic, building a professional online portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practising professional email communication, and researching cybercrime awareness. All work has been organised in a single GitHub repository and is documented in this report.

The goal of this project is not only to fulfil an academic requirement, but to genuinely develop skills that will be relevant throughout my engineering career — from communicating professionally online to staying safe in an increasingly digital world.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I created a one-page Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic using Canva, a free and browser-based graphic design tool that provides a wide range of templates, icons, and layout options suited for educational and professional visuals.

My infographic is designed as a single landscape slide and covers three core topics. The first section explains what Digital Literacy is, breaking it down into four key pillars: Find, Evaluate, Create, and Communicate , so that students can quickly understand what being digitally literate actually means. The second section highlights six useful digital tools for students, including GitHub, Google Workspace, Canva, LinkedIn, HackerRank, and Kaggle, with brief descriptions of each. The third section focuses on Email Etiquette, presenting a clear Do's and Don'ts table that outlines the most important rules for writing professional emails in an academic or workplace setting.

One thing I found particularly interesting while making this infographic was the challenge of balancing clarity with visual appeal. Fitting meaningful content into a single slide without making it look cluttered required several iterations of layout adjustments. Deciding which information to keep and what to simplify taught me a great deal about visual communication as a skill in itself something I had not fully appreciated before this task.

Task 2 – Building a Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I set up professional accounts on three key digital platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each of these platforms serves a distinct purpose in building a well-rounded digital presence as a student and aspiring engineer.

GitHub is a version control and code hosting platform widely used by developers, open-source contributors, and recruiters. I created a profile README on my GitHub account (https://github.com/saswatachakrabarti) that includes my name, branch, year, and a short note about the project . Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to host my academic projects, track my coding progress, and eventually contribute to open-source repositories.

LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform. I set up my profile with my current education details : including my degree, institution, and expected graduation year. Over the next four years, I plan to use LinkedIn to connect with seniors, faculty, and industry professionals, and to document internships, projects, and certifications as I progress through my degree.

Kaggle is a data science and machine learning platform that hosts datasets, competitions, and learning resources. I created an account on Kaggle to explore datasets relevant to my branch. In the coming years, I plan to use it to participate in beginner-level machine learning competitions and to build familiarity with data analysis , skills that will be increasingly important as I advance in my CSE curriculum.

Task 3 – Exploring Coding and Collaboration Platforms

Part A – Coding Practice on HackerRank

For the coding practice component of this task, I created an account on HackerRank and completed a beginner-level Java challenge. The problem required reading two integers from standard input and printing their sum , a fundamental exercise that tests knowledge of input handling, basic arithmetic, and program structure in Java.

The solution I submitted is as follows:

```
import java.util.*;
public class Solution {
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Scanner sc = new Scanner(System.in);
        int a = sc.nextInt();
        int b = sc.nextInt();
        System.out.println(a + b);
    }
}
```

Although the problem itself was straightforward, completing it on HackerRank helped me become familiar with the platform's code editor, test case system, and submission process. HackerRank will be a valuable resource for practising data structures and algorithms as I progress through my degree, particularly when preparing for technical interviews and coding competitions.

Part B – Google Workspace Collaboration

For the collaboration component, I created a Google Form titled 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' intended for my batchmates. The form contains five questions designed to test their understanding of digital literacy concepts. The questions included are:

- What does digital literacy mean?
- Which of the following is the safest password?
- What should you do if you receive a suspicious email link?
- Write one tip to stay safe online.
- How can you verify the reliability of a website?

The form includes both multiple choice questions and short answer questions, as required. Responses are automatically collected in a linked Google Sheet, which makes it easy to analyse the class's awareness levels. Google Workspace tools such as Forms and Sheets will continue to be useful for collaborative assignments, data collection, and academic reporting throughout my studies.

Task 4 – Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

For this task, I drafted two professional emails and created a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist. The experience of writing structured, formal emails reinforced the importance of clear and respectful digital communication.

One scenario where poor digital communication caused a real problem is the widely discussed case of employees sending casual, informal emails to senior management or clients using abbreviations, missing subject lines, or overly familiar language. In one hypothetical but realistic example, a student sends an email to their professor with no subject line and the message simply reading 'hey sir when is the deadline?' with no greeting, no identification, and no sign-off. As a result, the professor, who receives hundreds of emails, either ignores it or responds much later. The student misses the deadline and blames the professor for not responding in time.

What could have been done differently is straightforward: a clear subject line such as 'Query Regarding Assignment Deadline – CSE0001', a proper salutation, a one-line explanation of who the student is, a politely worded question, and a professional sign-off. This small change in structure and tone would have made the email easy to read, easy to respond to, and far more likely to receive a timely reply. This task made me realise that professional communication is a skill that must be practised deliberately , it does not come automatically.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study and Prevention Guide

For this task, I researched UPI and online payment fraud, which is one of the most prevalent and rapidly growing forms of cybercrime in India. The research involved understanding how such scams are structured, who they target, and what consequences victims face.

The thing that surprised me most while researching this topic was how technically simple most UPI frauds actually are. I had assumed that cybercrime involved sophisticated hacking tools or complex technical exploits. In reality, the majority of UPI scams rely almost entirely on social engineering , convincing the victim to willingly share their OTP or UPI PIN, or to approve a payment disguised as a receipt. The fraudster does not need to break into any system; they simply manipulate the victim's trust and lack of awareness. The fact that entering a UPI PIN is only ever required to send money ,never to receive it is something that many people, including students, do not know.

As a result of this research, one habit I will personally change is to never act on financial requests that arrive through unexpected calls, messages, or QR codes, no matter how urgent or official they appear. I will always verify independently before approving any digital payment. I will also make it a point to spread this awareness among my family members, particularly those who are new to digital payments.

Conclusion

This project has been a valuable and practical introduction to the many dimensions of digital literacy. Across the five tasks, I have learned to design visual communication material, build a professional online presence, practise coding on competitive platforms, write formal emails, and understand the nature of cybercrime threats in India.

Each task reinforced the idea that being digitally literate is not just about knowing how to use tools it is about using them responsibly, professionally, and safely. The GitHub repository I have built through this project will serve as the foundation of my digital portfolio throughout my engineering degree and beyond.

References

- Canva – Free Design Tool: https://www.canva.com
- GitHub – Code Hosting Platform: https://github.com
- LinkedIn – Professional Networking: https://www.linkedin.com
- Kaggle – Data Science Platform: https://www.kaggle.com
- HackerRank – Coding Practice: https://www.hackerrank.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal: https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930 (24x7)
- Google Forms – Collecting responses : https://forms.google.com